

HÖRMANN

A MATH ADVENTURE



For twenty years the best minds alive learned how to make a screen impossible to put down. **We are pointing that craft at arithmetic.**

PLAYABLE TODAY · BROWSER, PHONE, TABLET, DESKTOP

THE PREMISE

For twenty years we taught screens never to let go.

It worked. It is the most successful applied-psychology programme in history
– and the bill has arrived.

\$1.19T

spent on advertising worldwide in 2025 – the operating budget of the attention industry.¹

+9% / +12%

depression and anxiety disorder among students when Facebook reached their campus. Peer-reviewed and causal.²

42

attorneys general suing Meta for **deliberately designing addiction** into products used by children.³

MEANWHILE, AT SCHOOL

Iceland just posted its worst maths result on record.

Not a pandemic blip. The slide began before 2018, then accelerated into the steepest fall in the Nordics.

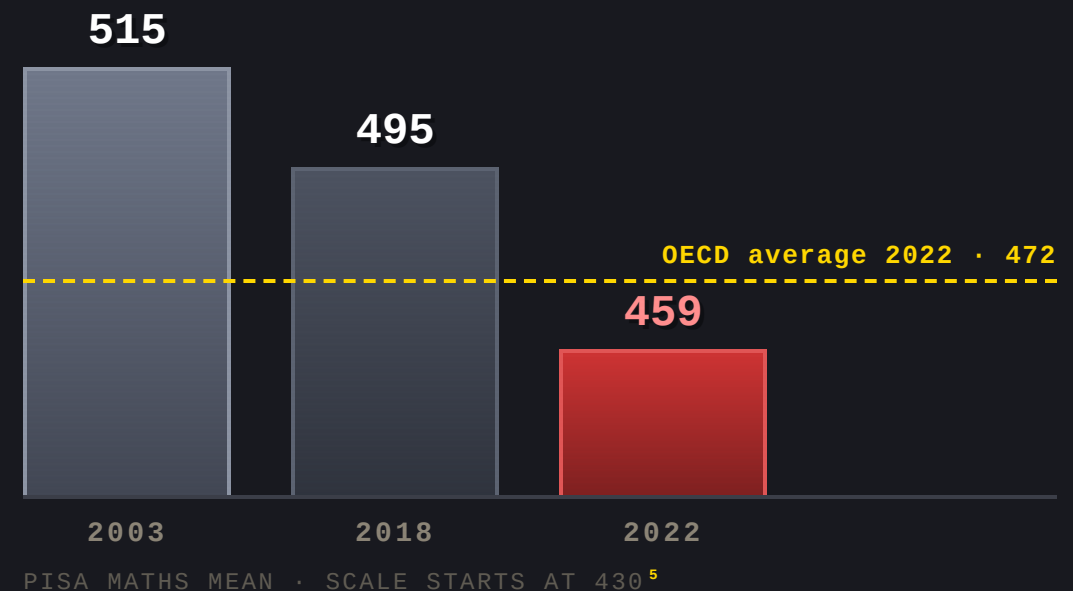
BELOW BASICS · MATHS

34% of 15-year-olds⁶

BELOW BASICS · READING

40% of 15-year-olds⁶

Basic reading proficiency fell **14 percentage points in one cycle**. Our Nordic neighbours fell three to eight.⁶ Maths is down **36 points since 2018** and **56 since the 2003 peak**.⁵



Attention got better at holding them. School did not.

THE IDEA

Same craft. Better target.

WHAT THE ATTENTION INDUSTRY PERFECTED

- ▶ Feedback in under a second
- ▶ Difficulty tuned so you are always just barely winning
- ▶ Reward that varies, so the next one might be the good one
- ▶ A reason to come back tomorrow
- ▶ Never let them feel stupid enough to leave

WHAT A CHILD LEARNING MATHS NEEDS

- ▶ Feedback in under a second
- ▶ Difficulty tuned so you are always just barely winning
- ▶ Reward that varies, so the next one might be the good one
- ▶ A reason to come back tomorrow
- ▶ Never let them feel stupid enough to leave

It is the same list. Nobody ever pointed it at times tables.

My son quits the second he smells failure.

ADHD, ODD, a high IQ, and a nervous system that wants stimulation before it will learn anything. He will fight a hard boss for two hours. He will not do ten minutes of worksheets.

Every learning app we tried lost him inside a week – too slow, too flat, or too honest about being a test.

I make games. So I stopped shopping and started building.

Immediate, or nothing

Children with ADHD need reinforcement that is **immediate, frequent and certain**. Delayed reward does not land – the dopamine signal never bridges the gap.⁸

The hardest user

Build for the child who is hardest to hold, and you have built something that holds everyone. He is the specification.

THE GAME

Every owl is locked. Maths is the key.



You are a crow

Run, jump, peck, collect coins. A real platformer, not a quiz with a sprite on it.

Owls wear padlocks

Each one is chained. They are in your way, and they need you.

You free them

Answer, and the chain comes off. Nobody is graded. Something is rescued.

Chess ratings, for a six-year-old's arithmetic.

Every answer moves the child's rating and the problem's rating. Difficulty chases the child – not the calendar, not the class average, not a grade level. Two children on the same screen play two different games, and neither one knows.

70–85%

the first-attempt accuracy band the shipped build holds a child inside: high enough to feel like winning, low enough that the maths still works.

≈85%

the optimal training accuracy for any gradient-learning system, human or artificial. **Nature Communications, 2019.**⁹

3,150

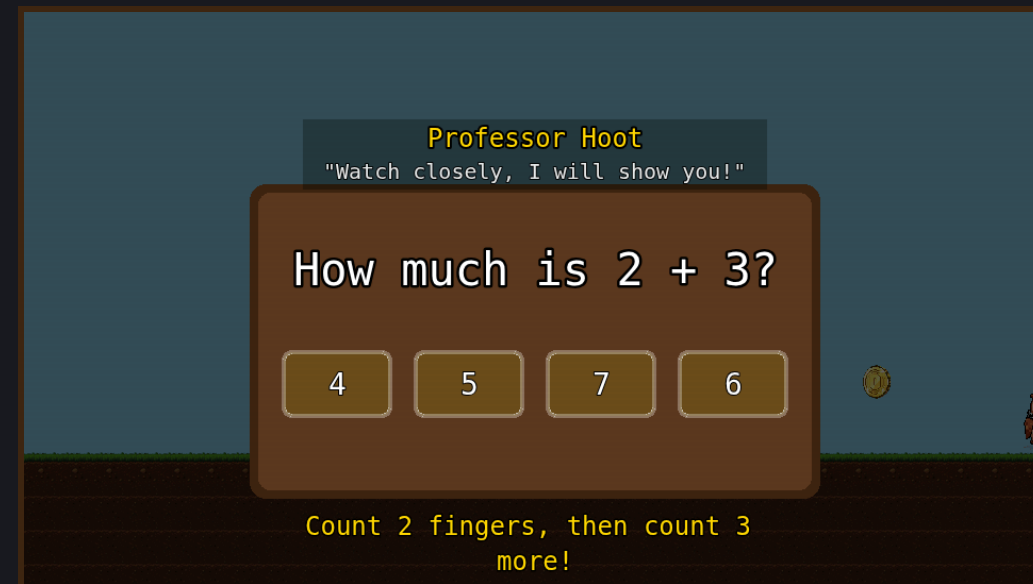
maths problems live in the build today, ladderred into curriculum steps with per-domain unlocks.

We deleted the moment a child feels stupid.

01 New maths is taught before it is asked. Professor Hoot works the example aloud, then hands over a free attempt that cannot count against you.

02 A second miss reveals the answer and explains it. A failed challenge ends in teaching, never in a red mark.

03 Getting right what you got wrong is the loudest celebration in the game. A miss becomes the setup for the best moment available.



A miss lowers difficulty **faster** than a win raises it. Demotions are never shown to the child: the game gets easier without ever saying so.

● ● ○ PROGRESS PIPS · EARNED, NEVER DRAINED

WHERE WE ARE

Not a concept. It runs.

3,150 problems live

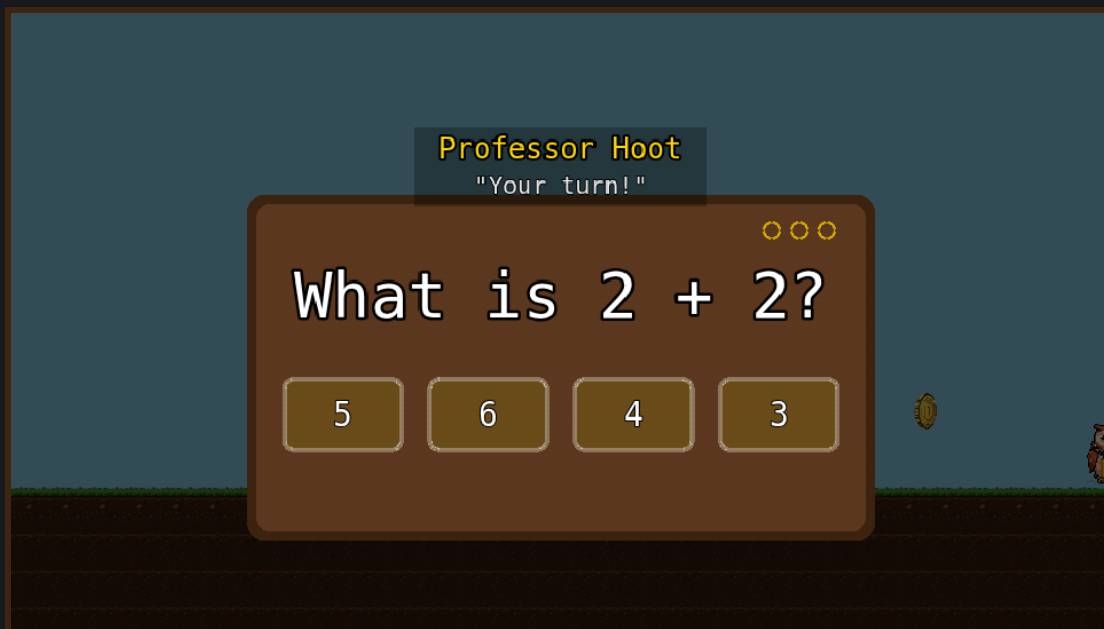
6 levels

Elo learner model

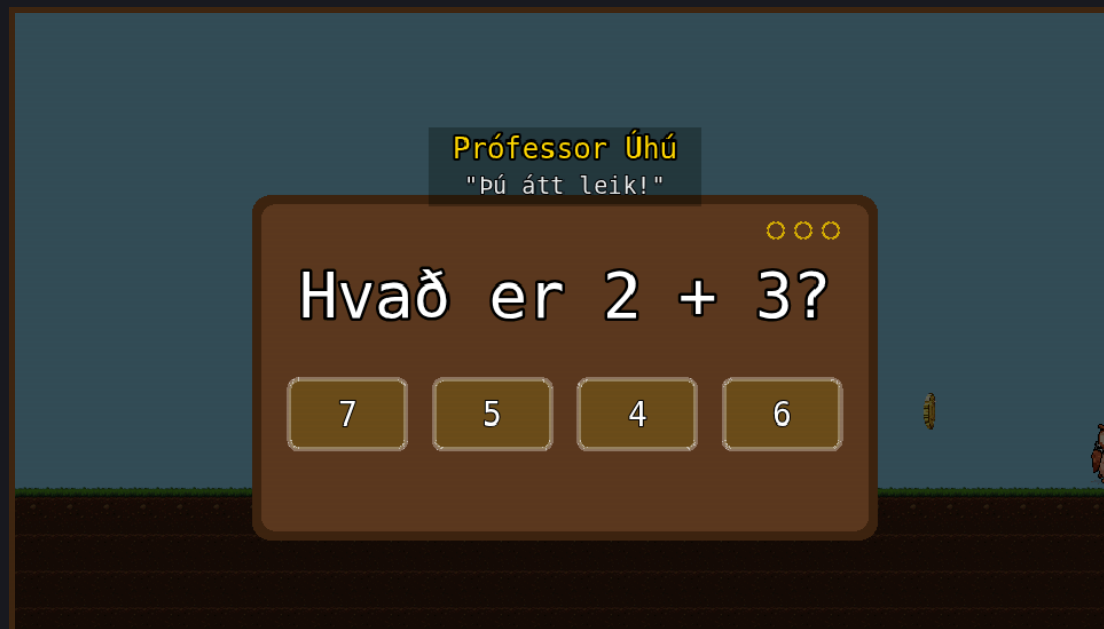
Per-child profiles & save sync

English + Icelandic

Teacher admin surface



LIVE ENCOUNTER · ENGLISH



SAME BUILD · ÍSLENSKA

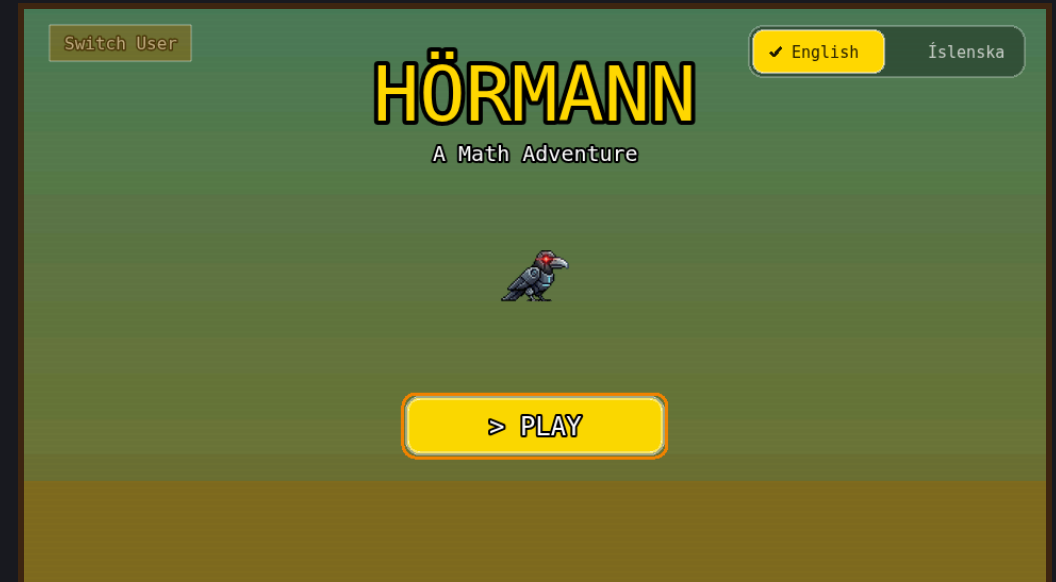
Every screenshot in this deck came out of the running build.

ACCESS

One build. Every screen a child already has.

- ▶ **Browser first.** A link, not an install. No procurement cycle, no IT ticket, no store review between a curious teacher and a lesson.
- ▶ **Phone, tablet, laptop, desktop.** Touch and keyboard both ship; the renderer already targets crisp 1080p with a separate mobile fit path.
- ▶ **Native apps where the store matters,** web everywhere else. Same engine either way.

The cheapest way into a classroom is to already be reachable.



A child signs in with a name and a four-digit PIN. **No email, no account, no parent onboarding funnel** – and a language switch on the title screen.

WHAT THIS BECOMES

Maths first. Then **everything** maths taught us.

■ IN THE CODE	Reskins. The theme is data, not code – forest and sci-fi already ship side by side. One engine, a different game for every kind of kid.
NEXT	Modes. The same arithmetic taught five different ways, because one way never reaches a whole class.
THEN	Subjects. The learner model does not know it is teaching maths. Growth mindset, movement, language – same engine, new content.
REACH	Nordics, then print. Localisation already ships. The book on the shelf sells the game, and the game sells the book.

We are not building a maths app. We are building the engine under it.

THE TEAM

Four people – if AI is the fifth.

Everything you have just seen was built by a solo founder with AI tooling.
The seats still open are the ones AI cannot sit in.

Founder

FILLED

Game development, product and design. The reason this exists.

Technical co-founder

OPEN

Owns the platform: sync, scale, apps, and the data the research will need.

Artist

OPEN

Art direction and the reskin pipeline – the seat that makes it a game kids want.

Teacher + academic

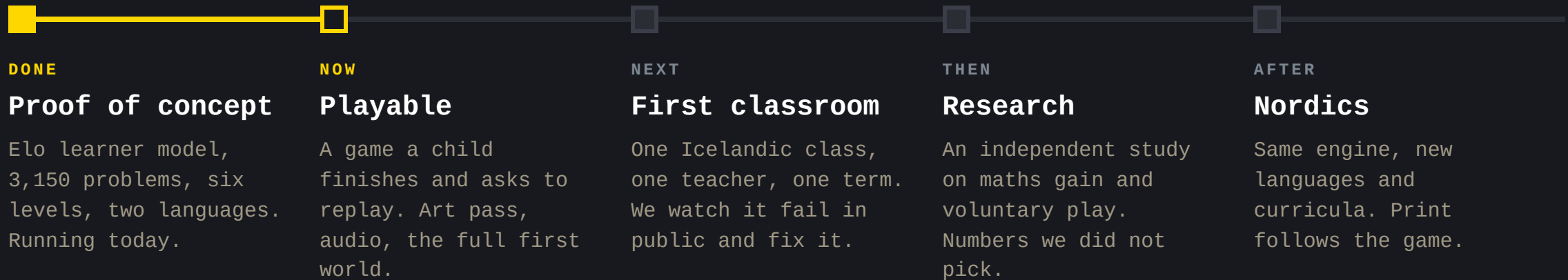
OPEN

Speaks the school's language, and runs the study that turns our claims into evidence.

Lean is not a constraint we tolerate. It is how we stay honest.

THE PLAN

From proof to evidence.



The milestone that matters is not a launch. It is a teacher asking for it back.

Leaders in language and quizzing. Nobody in maths.

**\$6.2B →
\$17.8B**

game-based learning, 2025 to 2030 –
a **23.4% CAGR**.¹¹

Duolingo · Kahoot!

the named category leaders. One owns language, one owns the classroom quiz. Kahoot! is Norwegian – the Nordics exported this playbook once already.¹¹

Maths is open

the subject with the steepest measured decline, the clearest right answer, and no game anyone names first.

We do not need the market. We need one classroom that refuses to give it back.

THE ASK

[amount] for [runway],
to get from a build to evidence.

WHAT IT BUYS

- ▶ Three hires: technical co-founder, artist, teacher/academic
- ▶ A finished, playable first world – art and audio complete
- ▶ The first Icelandic classroom pilot, run properly

WHAT IT PROVES

- ▶ Children choose it at home, unprompted¹⁰
- ▶ Measurable maths gain against a control group
- ▶ A teacher will fight to keep it – and a school will pay

The attention industry proved the method works. We are going to prove it can be aimed.

SOURCES

Every number, traceable.

- 1 WARC, Advertising grew 8.9% in 2025 – global ad spend closing 2025 at \$1.19 trn. [warc.com](https://www.warc.com)
- 2 Braghieri, Levy & Makarin, Social Media and Mental Health, American Economic Review 112(11), 2022. doi 10.1257/aer.20211218
- 3 42 state and territory attorneys general v. Meta, filed Oct 2023 – a 33-state joint federal suit plus nine individual filings. [njoag.gov](https://www.njoag.gov)
- 5 OECD, PISA 2022 Results – Country Note: Iceland. Maths mean 459 (2022), 495 (2018), 515 (2003); OECD average 472. [oecd.org](https://www.oecd.org)
- 7 Wang et al., Effects of digital game-based STEM education on students' learning achievement: a meta-analysis, Int. J. STEM Educ., 2022. 33 studies, N=3,894, ES 0.667. doi 10.1186/s40594-022-00344-0
- 8 Luman et al., Reinforcement Contingency Learning in Children with ADHD, Res. Child Adolesc. Psychopathol., 2019. doi 10.1007/s10802-019-00572-z
- 9 Wilson, Shenhav, Straccia & Cohen, The Eighty Five Percent Rule for optimal learning, Nature Communications 10:4646, 2019. doi 10.1038/s41467-019-12552-4
- 10 Klinkenberg, Straatemeier & van der Maas, Computer adaptive practice of Maths ability..., Computers & Education 57(2), 2011. Math Garden: 3,648 children, 3.5m problems in ten months, ~33% outside school hours. doi 10.1016/j.compedu.2011.02.003
- 11 MarketsandMarkets, Game-based Learning Market, Jul 2025: \$6.23 bn (2025) → \$17.82 bn (2030), 23.4% CAGR; leaders named as Duolingo, Kahoot!, Skillsoft. [marketsandmarkets.com](https://www.marketsandmarkets.com)
- Product figures – 3,150 problems, 6 levels, Elo learner model, the 70-85% band, EN/IS – come from the Hörmann repository's dated snapshot and architecture docs, verified against the running build.